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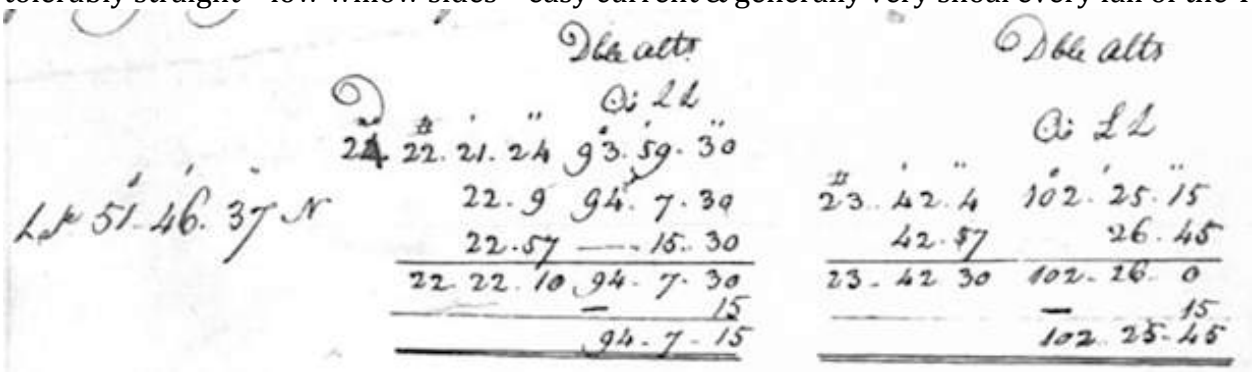
Journal of a Journey from Charlton House on the Red River Six Leagues above the Elbow of the Said River, down it to its entrance into Lake Wennepeg – & along the East Shores of this Lake to its Discharge where the Tracks meet going up the Saskatchewan River by the Great Rapid Cumberland House, with the Celestial Observations for Latitude Longitude, Variation of the Compass &c by Peter Fidler

April 24th Sunday – At 8 Am Myself & John Taylor left Charlton House, with 2 Horses to carry part of our necessaries, the other being sent away to the Elbow with John Ross three days ago – we are to embark there in a Canadian Batteaux & go down the Red [Assiniboine] River with it as far as where the first or upper settlement of the Albany people are – arrived at the Elbow at 2#.46' Pm. Course from Charlton House to the Elbow NEbE. 18 miles. The river 4 miles above the Elbow very crooked – above that tolerably straight – low willow sides – easy current & generally very shoal every fall of the Year.



25th Monday. at 11#.47' Am John Ross. John Taylor & myself Embarked from the Elbow of the Red River in a Canadian Batteaux 36 feet long & 12 feet wide. went down the River SEbS ½ E 7 miles & put up at 6#.45'. Pm – river very crooked, thick willow sides, running between high barren pined banks about ¾ mile Apart. a small Lake on the South Side Just above & one on North Side 1 mile below where we Encamped – A Small Hill appears down the river SSE ½ E 12 miles off – Several small Poplar Hammocks on both sides the River above the Banks – River from 10 to 20 yards wide.

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April 26th Tuesday – at 4#.20' Am got underway – went NE ½ S 5 & passed the White mud River on the West side, about 12 Yards wide. – SSE ½ S 4 miles & took the following observations to determine the Latitude

25.	23. 57. 30	103. 31. 15	
26.	0. 2. 25	— 26. 0	
	3. 43	— 24. 30	
	4. 45	— 22. 45	
	6. 9	— 20. 45	
	7. 25	— 18. 0	
26.	0. 3. 39	103. 23. 52	
		— 15	
		103. 23. 37	Lat 51. 36. 27 N

then went down the river SSE ½ S 2 a small River on South Side – a low level flatt on North side extending NE about 10 miles to the foot of Fort Dauphin Mountain – all the above courses & nearly all below, to the Entrance of the Pambina River are the Courses of the river between the high Banks – the River running very Crooked more than three times the distance winding from Bank to Bank of the High Ground – Course of the river from NNW on the right hand to NW on the Left – SSE ½ S 5 & put up at a Shoal ripple at 7 Pm about 2 miles above upper Poplar rivulet.

27th Wednesday – Got underway at 4#.25' Am – The Current ran on the 25th 2 ½ miles pr Hour – Yesterday 2 ¼ miles. – SSE ½ S 2 Little Poplar river on N Side falls out of a Swamp a short way from the Red River – SEbS 5 from Poplar River to bottom of the reach – altho the turnings here & above are not in general ¼ mile – fine low bank on South Side opposite the river & no wood – high Land within on North side – one mile above the bottom of the SE ½ E 5 mile course took the

104. 31. 0	
— 15	
104. 30. 45	Lat 51. 26 42 N.

April SSE ½ E 4 ½ & passed the lower poplar river that falls in on the North Side very Small – here is a Canadian House – built by Mr Cuthbert Grant several years ago – this rivulet falls out of the Same Swamp as the upper one does – a little above the House two small Creeks falls in from opposite sides. SbE 2 Stronger current than before – SEbE 2 Viancours Creek S Side where a Canadian was lost 7 Days – EbS 3 & put up at 7#.10' Pm – not so very crooked as before since we passed Grants House – Several Swampy small Lakes close along the river, below the High Banks – Several points of pretty large Elm we passed since the House. very uneven ground North Side in the face of the Bank –

28th Thursday – Got underway at 4#.10' Am. & went EbS 5 – SSE ½ E 4 & took the following observation.

Decl. ⊙: 22
105° 33' 0"
— 15
105. 32. 45 Lat. 51° 14' 39" N

a small Creek on North side just below where the observation was taken – SSE ½ E 2. – SE ½ E 3 – S 12 E 2 a large Gully on the South Side – S ½ E 1 – EbN 2 & put up at 7#.20' Pm – at a small rapid – a few maple on N Side & Birch on the South Side above – latter part of this day woods not so thick on North Side as above the lower banks of the river are in some places 4 to 5 feet above the adjacent Land.

29th Friday – at 4#.24' Am embarked & went ESE 1 – S5E 2 a large bluff of Elm & Maple Trees in the middle of the Valley – where the river runs remarkably Crooked 3 miles & comes round again within 100 Yards – SE ½ E 3 – SSE ½ S 4 the Banks on Both sides clearer of wood – S ½ E ¾ & passed Shell river, which falls in on the left or North side about 15 Yds wide – comes out of Fort Dauphin Mountain – here the first Oak Trees are seen, tho very small. – a small willow Island at rivers mouth – S ½ E 1 ¼ – The first plain on South Side about 5 Miles above Shell river – SWbW 3 & put up at 6#.40' Pm where 3 Old Houses are but now not inhabited. Very bad woods for building a House all the way we have come

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April 30th Saturday – Got underway at 4#.5' Am & went S1 – SEbE 5 Good Poplar on both sides – SSE 1

Deckat. 8. 22

107.. 34. 30
15
107.. 34. 15 Lat. 50.. 50.. 58 N.

SSE 1 – S2 – SSE ½ E 7 & arrived at James Inksters House at 5 Pm – he had got every thing into his two Batteaux ready for Embarking – but a band of Inds came in which detained him – we went SbE ½ S 1 & put up – we shall proceed down the river a few miles farther in the Canadian Batteaux to the Passage overland to the Calling river House, & then embark in the Albany Batteaux to Brandon House.

May 1st . Sunday – Embarked at 4#.10' Am & went SbE ½ S 5 – SE 2 – SbE ½ E 2. & took the

Deckat. 8. 22

108.. 44. 0
15
108.. 43. 45 Lat. 50.. 34. 22 N.

SbE ½ S 2 & came to the Passage or Track overland from this to Calling river house – went by Land to the House to purchase a Small Canoe from Mr McDonald the Canadian Master as our people has nothing of the Kind fit for our purpose – W ½ S 2 ½ & passed over a stout Creek the Horn Mountain a Small hill being on my Left ½ mile off. SW ½ S 4 across a fine level Grass plain – no wood. & came to edge of Calling river, went up it SW ½ W 2 ½ & arrived at the French House. agreed with the Canadian Master for a Canoe the price to be 21 lb of Shot Low India – 36 Yew handle Knifes & a Second hand 3 ½ feet Gun. – the Canoe is at the Pine fort 18 miles below Brandon House – Calling river between the high banks ½ mile & runs very crooked between them – this a low Valley – comes out of Lakes & has a Communication with the Moose Woods in the South Branch River as

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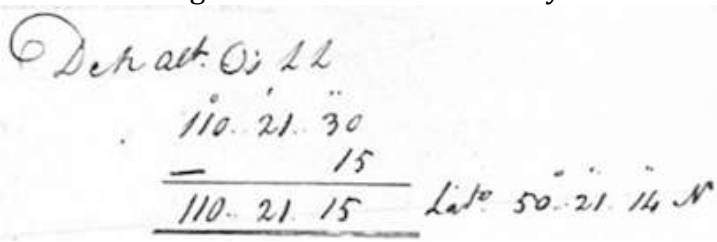
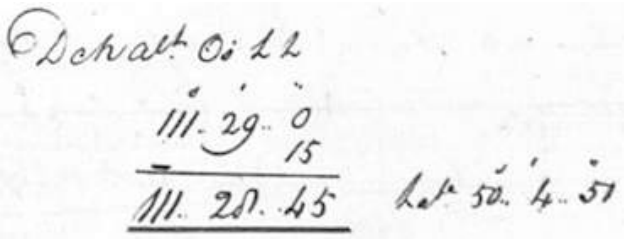
May 2nd Monday – at 10 0/4 left the Canadian House & returned back the same way. & found James Inkster with his 2 Batteaux who had arrived 1 hour before me – we proceeded down the Red River – leaving the French Batteaux here in care of a Canadian – went SE 6 ½ & put up at 6 ½ Pm – The trees all nearly covered with leaves – except the Oaks –

3rd Tuesday – Embarked at 4#.20' Am went SE ½ & passed the mouth of River Qui appelle or Calling river on the right hand – ESE ½ S 4 a bay in the River & deep Gully on North side – SE ½ E 6.



Lower banks than these 2 or 3 Days past. SSE ½ E 7 a Creek on South Side – very little wood on either side – A small river on North Side called Bird Tail Creek – a low valley bottom of last reach – ESE ½ E 5 a pretty stout Creek on South side in middle of the reach – SEbE 3 & put up at 6 ¾ Pm – very Cold weather these 2 Days past.

4th Wednesday – Got underway at 4#.57' Am & went ESE 2 – SSE 2 a deep Gully on South side – SSE 3 – E 3.



Taken ½ mile above Grand Bois House on South side – very little wood Yestdy – E 2 several pretty good points of Maple & Oak – SE 5 the Hills of Mountain La Bosse upper end begins here – SbE 3 two deep Gullies & Creeks on North Side & put up at 6#.50' Pm.

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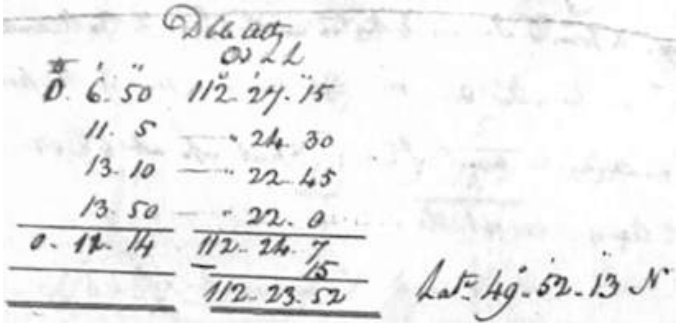
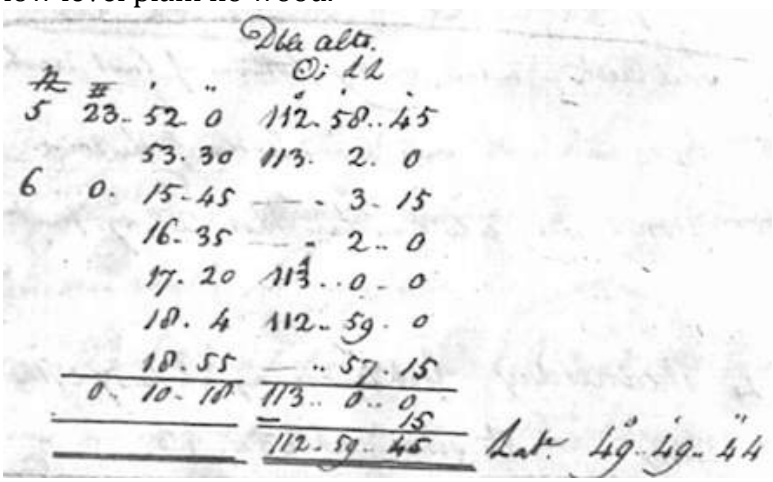
May 5th Thursday Embarked at 5#.4' Am & went SbE 1 – SEbS 3 – SSE 3. EbS 1



	Dble alt. ⊙ LL	
D. 6. 50	112. 27. 15	
11. 5	— . 24. 30	
13. 10	— .. 22. 45	
13. 50	— . 22. 0	
0. 12. 14	112. 24. 7	
	15	
	112. 23. 52	Lat. 49°. 52. 13 N

Dble alt about 112°. 28'.. 30" ⊙ LL – Watch about 4 ½ or 5' too fast.
EbS 2 Mountain La Bosse House on the top of the High Bank on South Side. here the river makes longer sweeps than above from High bank to high Bank across the Valley – EbN 3 A small Creek on S Side EbS 1 & put up at 6#.57' – High banks about 1 mile apart & easier current than above.
6th Friday Got underway at 6 Am & went EbS 2 a little wood here & very scarce above except at Grand Bois on South Side – EbN 4 banks rather lower NEbE 2 upper end of Buffalo plain on North side – a fine low level plain no wood.



	Dble alt. ⊙ LL	
5 23. 52. 0	112. 58.. 45	
53. 30	113. 2. 0	
6 0. 15. 45	— . 3. 15	
16. 35	— . 2.. 0	
17. 20	113.. 0. 0	
18. 4	112. 59. 0	
18. 55	— .. 57. 15	
0. 10. 10	113.. 0.. 0	
	15	
	112. 59. 45	Lat. 49°. 49. 44

These & the aforementioned Double altitudes are taken, by reason of the Sun not being clear at Noon – Went NNE 5 a hill appears ahead from where the observations were taken about 8 or 10 miles off. – at the End of last Course arrow wood river on North Side small – NE 5 & put up at 6 Pm very level low banks these 2 last reaches – no wood only a little on the points – river 50 Yds wide here or more running in Long bends from Bank to Bank 1 ¼ mile distant – Not a Scrap of wood on either side at arrow wood River – rain from 4 to 7 Pm – very Bad weather.

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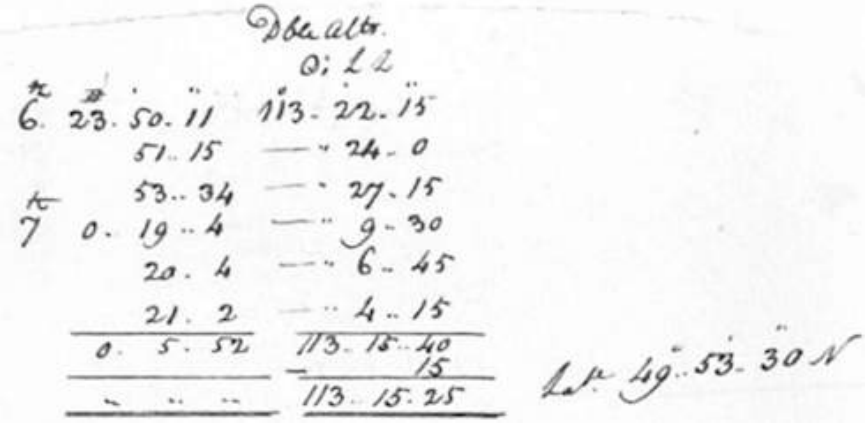
May 7th Saturday. Embarked at 5# am & went NE 2 – ENE ½ N 2 – EbN 2 a high round Knowl here on North side called the Beggars Hill – a little wood on South side under the Bank – EbS 1



Beggars Hill from this observation WbN 2 miles. pretty steep banks on both sides, but very little wood. – EbS 2 very crooked – no Maple Yesterday or this Day – Passed several excellent places of very fine Large Oak Trees – EbN 4 & passed the Rapid river on our left hand. pretty strong current. formerly Trading Settlements built here – a Long reach EbN 2 – Tolerable wood on South Side but none on Same side 1 mile below the Houses – Shoal, strong current. – from E to EbN 9 miles nearly straight & put up at the Lower end of an Island about 2 miles Long – at 7#.40'.

8th . Sunday – Embarked at 4#.57' Am near EbN 7 & passed Oak Creek on our left river pretty straight – Low Banks on both sides since rapid River – – EbN 1 ½ & came to the Barrier a pretty strong Shoal rapid, went down it – – SE 2 an Island & lower end of the rapid – 2 other smaller rapids between this & the Barrier, bare banks 2 miles below Oak Creek on both sides – SEbE ¾ strong current & passed a Canadian House. remained here 1 hour near SE 4 – NNE 1 ¼ an Is^d – WbS ½ D^o – near NE ½ – near SSE 1 three Ids – E ½ – SSE ¾ – ENE ½ shoal rapid – SSW ¼ N End Moose Hill House SW ½ W 8 miles – SSW ¼ – SSE ¾ – SE ½ – ESE ½ . from NE to SSW 3 miles makes SEbE 2 all pretty strong Current & arrived at Brandon House at 3#.40' Pm. Many Inds. Sauteux, Bungees & Stone Inds tenting here.

May 9th Monday –

☾ Deck alt. ☉ ☌ ☾ 115° 3′ 30″
— 15
115° 3′ 15″ Lat. 49° 40′ 29″ N

Dble alts. ☉ ☌ ☾
56° 59′ ☉ long 8s 70½ W
27 — 71½
55 55 — 72½
56 27 15 — 71 30
56 26 45

Dble alts. ☉ ☌ ☾
4h 16′ 17″ — 54° 52′ 30″
17 0 — 39 15
17 37 — 27 0
4 16 50 — 54 39 35
+ 14 10 — 15
4 31 6 — 54 39 20

Variation 12° 12′ East.

Observations of the Total Lunar Eclipse May 9th 1808

		Long. W.
Beginning of Eclipse of Water	11h 1′ 0″	99 41 4
Beginning of Total Darkness	11 59 30	99 35½
End of Total Darkness	13 33 0	99 29
End of the Eclipse	14 32 0	99 14
Mean of the Whole		99 29 56

Very clear Calm night – Moon reddish but still visible – very good sight from Beginning to End – observed with an achromatic Telescope magfn 35 times

Dble alts. ☉ ☌ ☾
20h 41′ 35″ — 83° 21′ 0″
42 24 — 34 30
43 12 — 48 15
20 42 24 — 83 34 35
+ 18 40 — 15
21 1 4 — 83 34 20

10th

☾ Deck alt. ☉ ☌ ☾ 115° 34′ 0″
— 15
115° 33′ 45″ Lat. 49° 40′ 57″ N

Dble alts. ☉ ☌ ☾
4h 59′ 12″ — 39° 36′ 0″
5 0 11 — 17 0
1 0 — 1 45
5 0 0 — 39 18 15
+ 19 40 — 15
5 19 57 — 39 18 0

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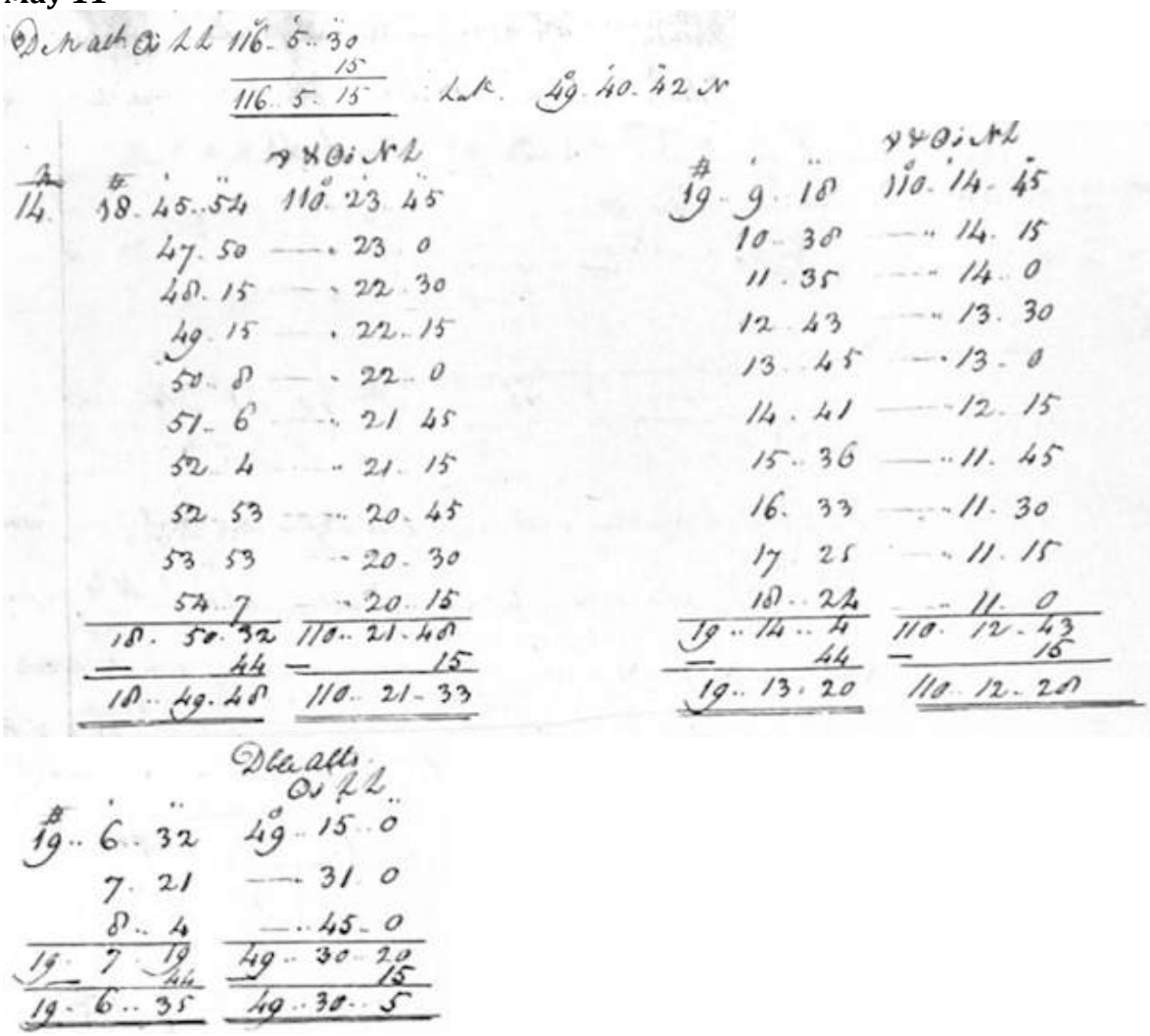
May 11th



Dr Nath ⊙ & ☾	116° 5′ 30″	
	15	
	116° 5′ 15″	Lat. 49° 40′ 42″ N

		☾ ⊙ N ☾
14	18 45 54	110° 23′ 45″
	47 50	— 23 0
	48 15	— 22 30
	49 15	— 22 15
	50 8	— 22 0
	51 6	— 21 45
	52 4	— 21 15
	52 53	— 20 45
	53 53	— 20 30
	54 7	— 20 15
	18 50 32	110 21 40
	— 44	— 15
	18 49 48	110 21 33

		☾ ⊙ N ☾
19	9 18	110° 14′ 45″
	10 38	— 14 15
	11 35	— 14 0
	12 43	— 13 30
	13 45	— 13 0
	14 41	— 12 15
	15 36	— 11 45
	16 33	— 11 30
	17 25	— 11 15
	18 24	— 11 0
	19 14 4	110 12 43
	— 44	— 15
	19 13 20	110 12 28

		Dr Alt ☾
19	6 32	49° 15′ 0″
	7 21	— 31 0
	8 4	— 45 0
	19 7 19	49 30 20
	— 44	15
	19 6 35	49 30 5

The above Lunar Observations smoaky air the moon rather Dim.

16th Monday – at 7#.40' Am I left Brandon House in Company with Mr John McKay & 4 Batteaux, went down the Red River as before from NNE to S 4 ½ making EbS 3 miles, & passed the Sandfly river or Sourie on the South side, about 25 Yards wide – Steep banks on both sides the river Saw a number of Indians here. – a Creek 2 miles below the House N Side & another on same side ½ mile below Sourie river – ESE not very crooked 6 miles. NbW 1 ½ – N ½ – NEbN 1 some pines here the only ones we have seen since we left the Elbow 25th April – several shoal ripples – ESE ¼ – SSW ½ – ESE ¾ – Crooked making ENE 4 & put up at 6#.35' at the upper end of the bare sandy hills on North side – Passed 3 or 4 Islands of wood this Day.

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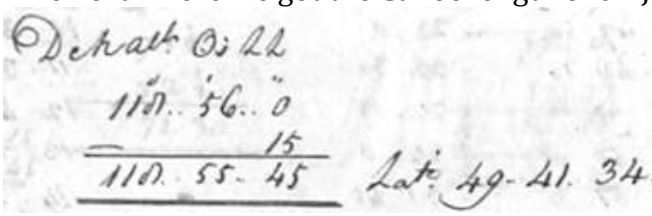
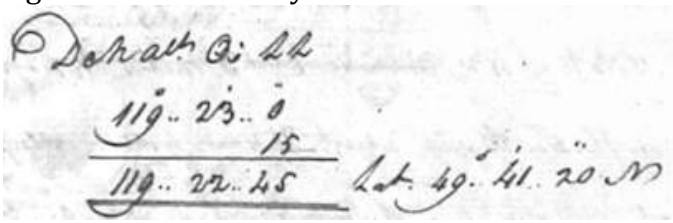
May 17th Tuesday – at 5#.5' AM got underway – passed several odd places of maple Yesterday – Went from SSW on the right, to to SSW on the left, or all round the Compass making NbE ½ E 4 & arrived at the Pine Fort where we got the Canoe length of cH Jn' McDonell. – Went SE ½



["43" in margin beside lat]

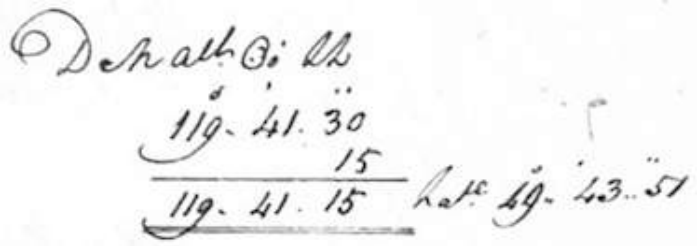
Then went 4 miles making EbN ½ N 1 & Passed the Rock river, small – on the North Side high banks nearly 2 miles apart. EbN ½ N 4 & passed the Cypress River on the South side – small. a Deal of small wood on both sides of the river Yesterday & this Day – none above. NE 3 & put up at 5 PM to pitch our Canoe, as he is remarkably leaky & besides rather too small to go along Lake Winnipeg with

18th Wednesday – Got underway at 5#.10' NE 3 formerly an Island here on the right, river narrow here – ENE 1 ½ Dehorums House North side in good Poplars – ENE 1 ½ & came to the Pine Creek on the Left, where are the lower end of the Pines in this river near the Water. ENE 3 another Pine Creek on South or right hand side & very end of the Pines –



The banks here come within ¼ mile of each other – River about 60 or 70 Yards wide – NEbN ¾ - SEbE ¾ near NE 2 a rip of rocks 20 feet below the Surface on South Side – near NE 1 – NW ½ - near NEbE 2 – between NW & SSE – ENE ½ between SSW & NNW generally from bank to bank ¾ mile apart making ENE 5 – NEbN 1 & passed the half way Creek on N S Trading Houses here lately inhabited – SSW 1 & put up at 5#.40' Pm.

May 19th Thursday – Strong & Stronger Current since the observation – by the General Account of every person, the Red river is very shoal all the Way up in the latter End of Summer, that the Batteaux & Canoes have much difficulty in going up at that time even with ½ Cargo. the Horses meeting the Craft at the entrance of the Pambina River. above the Elbow scarcely an Empty Canoe could be floated by the Water. a number of small shoal stony ripples – & number less bars of sand impedes much the Navigation at that Season – at 5#.25' AM Embarked & went ESE ½ - NE ½ - NNW ½ - NW ½ NNE ½ a French House on North side & 2 small willow Is ENE ½ - E ½ - ESE 1 - NE ½ several Pine Hammocks of Maple here – EbS ¾ - SE ¼ - E ½ - SSE ½ - SE ¼ - NE ⅛ - NWbN ½ NNE ¼ - ESE ¼ - SSE ¾ a Willow Is – E ¼ – NE ¼ - NbW ¾ upper end of the Big Swamp on the North side – NE ¼ - SEbS 1 - EbS ¼ - ENE ¾ - EbS ½ ENE ¼ .

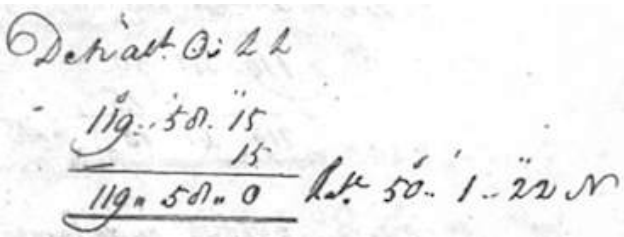


Thick Smoaky Air since the 15th could never See the Moon or Stars to Observe for the Longitude – NW 1 – NbW ½ - EbS ½ - NE ½ - NW ½ lower end of the Big Swamp on N Side – WbN ¼ - SWbS ½ - NW ¼ - NE 1 – NW 1 3 willow Is – NEbE two Willow Is & put up at 5#.55' – River from 50 to 100 Yds wide No Rapids below half way Creek – Banks well covered with Poplars. Elms Oak Brush &c no barren Ground to be seen from the river on either side – half way Creek bank very steep.

20th Friday – Embarked at 5#.53' AM & went NNE ¼ - ENE ½ - wide & many Sand Banks Yesterday – NE ½ - EbN ¼ - N ¼ - NWbW ½ - NNE ¼ - ENE ¼ - SE ¼ - SW ¼ - E ⅛ - NE ¼ - NNW ¼ - WNW ½ - NNW ¼ - NE ¾ - EbN ½ near N 1 – E ½ - SE ⅛ & arrived at Portage de Prairie (House) a level Plain stopt at the House 3 Hours & then proceeded & went SSE ¼ - E ⅛ - NEbE ¼ Old French Fort here about a Century ago in North Side – a willow Pt ESE ¼

May Sturgeon River – ENE ½ - NE ½ - NWbN ½ a bare plain on North side – E ½ SEbS ½ - EbN ½ - NE ½ - SSE ½ - ESE ½ - NEbE ½ Inksters Island & put up at 7#.7' plenty of white wood this Day – none higher up the river – very Cold weather, a little Snow & Strong gale at NW.

21st Saturday – Snow fell in the Night 4 inches & lay on the ground till noon before it melted away. got underway at 6#.44' AM & went ENE ½ - NNE ½ - NbW ¾ - NE ½ - ESE ½ - NE ½ - NEbN ½ - NE ½ - ESE ½ - SSE ½ - E ½ - NNE ½ - EbN ½ - SE ½ - E ½ - NE ½ - ESE ½ - NNE ½ - NNW ½ ESE ½ - WNW ½ E ½ - ENE ½ - NNW ½ - WNW ½ - WbS ½ - WNW ½ Loutits creek NS - NEbE - a Plain on North side comes to the river edge – all above large level Plain or Meadow on North Side – NE ½ plenty of fine Oaks in all the Bays & white wood Poplars &c on the Points – E ½ - NNW ½ - NE ½ - SE ½ - S ½ - ENE ½ - N ½ - NW ½ - NNE ½



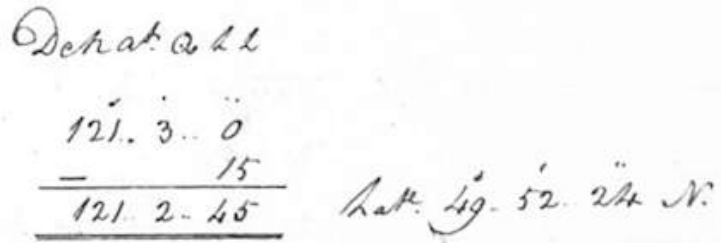
["45" in margin beside lat]

NE ½ - NW ½ - NE ½ - EbN ½ very fine Oaks on both sides – NNE ½ - NWbN ½ - NE ¼ - ESE ½ - SEbE ½ - SEbS ½ - SE ½ - SEbN ¾ - ESE ½ - ENE ½ - NEbE ½ NE ½ - NNW ½ - NE ½ - SSE ½ - EbN ½ - NEbE ½ - ENE ½ - SSE ½ - EbN ½ - S E ½ - NNE ½ - SSE ½ - NbW ½ - E ½ - SSE ½ - ESE ½ - NEbN ½ - SE ½ - SWbS ½ - E ½ - SE ½ - SSW ½ - SEbS ½ - NE ½ - SE ½ - SW ½ & put up at 6#.20' PM. we go along very slowly every day doing little more than barely driving along with the Current

22nd Sunday – Got underway at 6#.0' – NE ½ - ENE ½ - NE ¼ - E ½ - SSE ½ - WSW ½ - SE ½ found here 2 Tents of Freemen Canadians got from them 160 MB NE ½ - ESE ¼ - SW ½ - E ½ - NbW ½ - River narrower Yesterday & this Day than before – WNW ½ - NE ½ - SE ½ - EbN ½ - NEbE ½ small Creek N S – E ½ - SEbS ½ ENE ½ - NbW ½ - SEbS ½ - E ½ - NNE ½ - SSE ½ - SSW ½ - ESE ½ - NEbN ½ -

May E ½ - SEbE ½ - upper part pretty straight lower part more crooked 10 miles makg ESbE 4 - SEbS ½ - ESE ¼ - ENE ¼ - SSW ½ - NNE ½ - ENE ½ Oaks now are smaller than above – SSE ½ - SSW ½ - E ½ - NE ½ - SSW ½ - ESE ½ - NEbE ½ - ENE ½ - N ¼ Kettle Plain on North Side – SW ½ - W ½ - SE ½ - E ½ - SEbE ¾ - EbN ½ - S ½ - SE ½ - E ½ - N ½ - NNW ½ White Horse Plain N S. – E ½ - NW ½ W ½ - E ½ - NE ½ - ESE ¼ & put up at 5#.20'. Rain at Night.

23rd Monday – Embarked at 5#.23' AM. went S ½ - SW ¼ - S ½ - SE ¼ - E ½ - NNE ½ E ½ - SE ½ - SSW ¼ - SE ¼ - E ½ - NEbE ½ - S ½ - SW ½ - WbS ½ - S ½ - ESE ½ - SEbS ½ - Salt Spring on S S. – ENE ¼ - EbN ¼ no wood North Side – SSE ½ - SbW ¼ - SWbW ½ - SE ½ - E ½ - NNE ½ - NW ½ - NE ½ - ESE ½ - SSE ½ - ENE ¼ - S ½ - W ¼ - SW ½ another Salt Spring on South Side – SE ½ - NE ½ - NWbN ½ - NEbN ½ no wood North Side – SE ¼ - E ½ - NNE ¼ - EbN ¾ but few Sand banks in the river compared to high up – SEbE ½ - E ½ - NE ¼ - no Stones at the rivers edge this Day & part. – here a few. – ESE ¼ - NE ½ - NEbE NEbE ¾ Lyons Isd & upper end of the Small rapids – EbN ¼ - SWbS ¼ - SW ½ NEbE ¾ - NNE ¼ - E ½



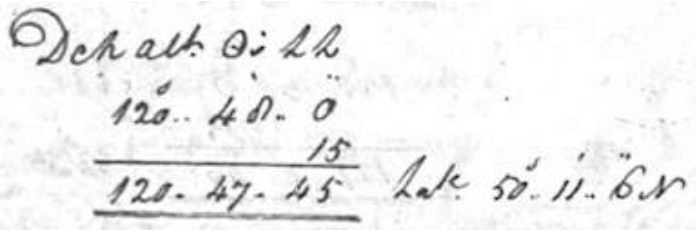
["47" in margin beside lat]

NEbE ¼ - NE ½ - EbS ½ - EbN ½ - SSE ½ - N ½ - NWbN ½ - ENE ½ - NEbN ½ a Creek North Side - EbN ½ a Strong ripple all above from Lyons Isd stony current & very Shoal every Autumn – NEbE ½ - EbN ¼ - NEbN ½ a ripple – EbN ½ ENE ½ - ESE ½ - E ½ - ENE ½ - NNW ½ stony on both sides & a ripple – with small variations 5 miles making ENE ½ N 4 & came to the Entrance of the Pambina or Southern Branch of the Red River at 2#.35' – several small ripples 2 miles above the Forks in North Branch & narrow & easy current below the rapids – Forks open S ½ mile 120 Yds wide easy current – Continued down the two united streams NW ¾ - NbE ¼ - EbN ½ a Creek on South Side – WNW ¾ N ¼ - NEbE ½ - NbW ½ - NWbN ½ - NEbN ½ - NEbE - NNW ½ a Plain on

["Forks" in margin beside "Southern Branch of the Red River"]

May the North Side – EbN ½ - NbE 1 – NbW 1 – NNE ¼ - N ½ & put up at 5#.40' PM – remarkable easy current since the Forks – rather low banks, muddy with tolerable woods on South Side – & less on the North Side.

24th Tuesday at 5#.5' AM got underway & went NbE ¼ shoal & stony – NNW 1 ¼ Stony Bank N S – NE ¼ - NbE ½ - NEbE ¼ - EbN ¼ - NbE ¼ - NEbN ¼ - NNW ½ - NbE ½ - EbS ¼ a shoal ripple – NEbN ¼ - NNW ¼ - NE ¼ strong Current since the first two reaches this Morning – Six reaches making NbW 1 ¾ all strong current & rocks in the Bay on North Side, a Plain close to the river on N Side & the last one. – in high winds in Lake Winnipeg the water dams up this river here to the foot of the rapids. – NbW ¼ - ENE ½ three reaches making NEbN 1 – E ½ - NE ¼ River 200 Yards wide, low grassy banks & very little wood & very easy Current. – NNE ¼ - WNW ½ - NEbN ½ two Good Points of Maple – none above since the Forks – N ¼ Creek on S Side NW ½ - a Poplar Island & a stout creek at the Head of it on South Side NEbN 1 Two Old Canadian Houses on N Side.



This observation taken in the Middle of this last reach on North Side – a Stout Creek at head of it on North Side & opposite the French Houses a Good Stout Creek on opposite side – NNW ½ - NNE ½ - NWbN ¾ near NNW. 2 miles in 3 reaches – NWbN 1 – NbW 1 – NW 2 banks very low, particularly on North Side & only willows & small maple – a few oaks this Day above a Stout Creek ½ mile from bottom of last reach on North Side & at the bottom of it on same Side Dead River by the French or Nettley Creek by our people found here several families of Bungees & Towees [Ojibwa & Ottawa]. who have planted some acres of Indian Corn & Potatoes – & pays great attention to it – last year was the

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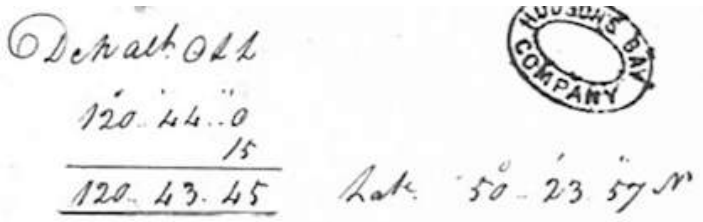
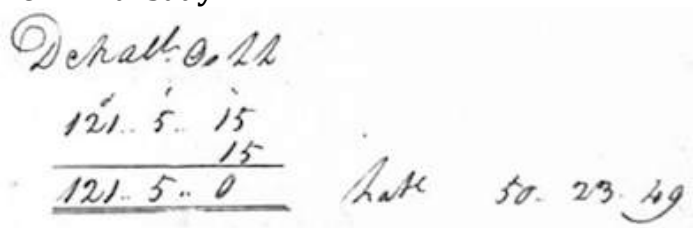
May first – as our Canoe was very leaky & quite unfit for Lake Winnipeg we left it here & purchased another from the Indians – remained here 1 Hour & embarked – They inform us that Messrs Hugh Henry & Stett had passed here few Days ago. – Proceeded down the river NbE 1 – NNE 1 a small Branch on South Side & put up Here at 5#.0' a Strong wind ahead all afternoon.

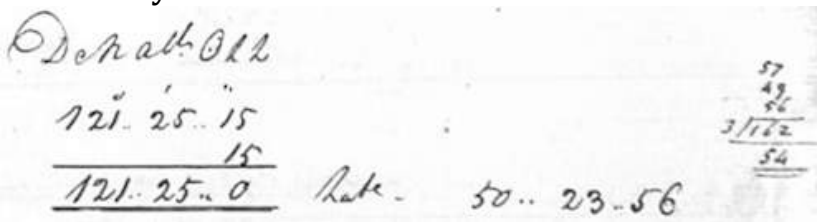
25th Wednesday at 5#.30' AM got underway & went NbW 1 – NNW 1 a large branch on the South Side – & a small one on the North. – NbW ¾ - N ½ a small branch on the North Side – NNE ½ a middling branch S S & not more than 50 Yds wide – NEbE ¼ - NEbE ¼ a small Creek S S – NNE ½ - NE ½ & came to the mouth of the Red river & entrance of Lake Winnipeg where we was obliged to remain for Wind. very low wet Swampy Land near the Lake & no wood – the ridges of Pines at the Dry Land is 4 or 5 miles from us on both sides.



26th Thursday –



27th Friday –



Strong Gales at NW Night & Day could not Embark.

28th Saturday at 4 ¾ AM got underway & went close along the right hand shore of Lake Winnipeg the following Courses – ENE 4 & passed a Small river. NEbN 3 Sturgeon Point & passed two other small rivers – NbW 6 a low gravel point **A** NW ½ - N 1 ½ NbW 1 ¼ - N 6 & put up at 7#.30' PM. lay by 6 Hours for wind

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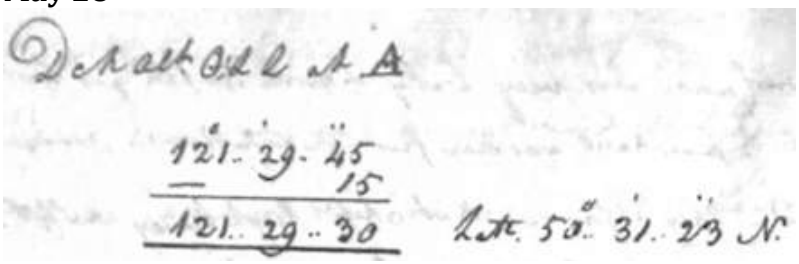
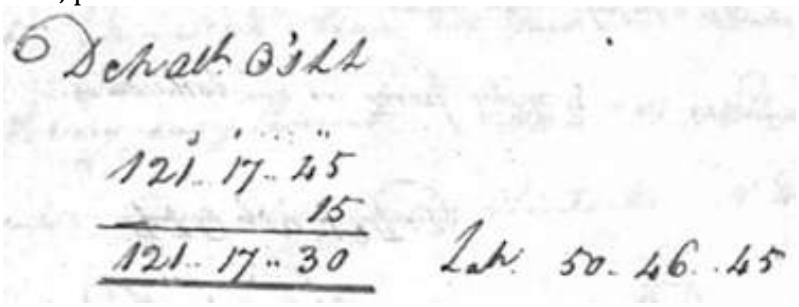
May 28th

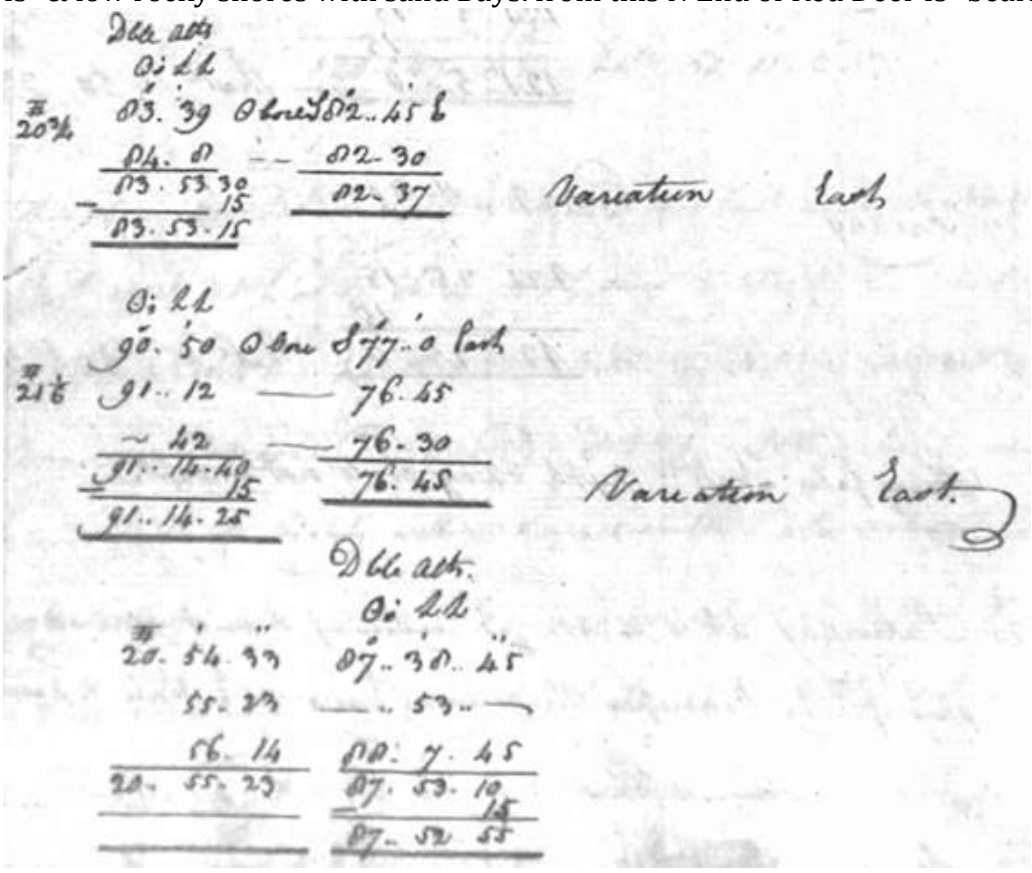


["50" in margin beside lat]

29th Sunday Embarked at 3#.50' AM & went along the right hand or Eastern Shore of Lake Winnipeg N ½ W 5 ½ to the N End of Red Deer Isd [Elk Island] sometimes carry over a narrow Isthmus 100 Yds & when the water is high can be avoided along the Island N ½ - NNE 1 – NE ¼ the entrance of river Winnipeg from here is SE ½ E – here we left Mr Jno McKay & crossed over the Deep Bay EbS 5 ½ miles to the other side, parted with him at 9#.20' AM. NbE 4 –



NNW 4 – NNW ½ W 3 - NbW 4 S 1 – NNW ¾ S 1 ½ - NWbW 4 ½ & put up at 7 ¼ PM – several small rocky Isd & low rocky shores with sand Bays. from this N End of Red Deer Isd bears WbS



1808

May 29th

22. 39. 45	61. 22. 0	
40. 40	22. 30	
41. 42	23. 0	
42. 34	23. 15	
43. 40	23. 45	
44. 31	24. 15	
45. 17	24. 45	
46. 8	25. 0	
47. 0	25. 30	
47. 48	26. 0	
22. 43. 55	61. 24. 0	
		15
		61. 23. 45

30. 0. 4. 40	62. 2. 15	
5. 34	2. 45	
6. 35	3. 15	
7. 21	3. 30	
8. 20	4. 0	
9. 16	4. 15	
10. 5	4. 30	
10. 54	5. 0	
11. 36	5. 30	
12. 23	5. 45	
0. 8. 40	62. 4. 4	
		15
		62. 3. 49

30th

30. 2. 4. 40	62. 52. 0	
6. 33	52. 15	
7. 18	52. 45	
8. 3	53. 0	
8. 48	53. 30	
9. 38	53. 45	
10. 30	54. 0	
11. 18	54. 15	
12. 4	54. 45	
12. 48	55. 0	
2. 9. 10	62. 53. 31	
		15
		62. 53. 16

Dehalt O. Ll

120. 59. 45
15
120. 59. 30

Lat. 51. 4. 45 N

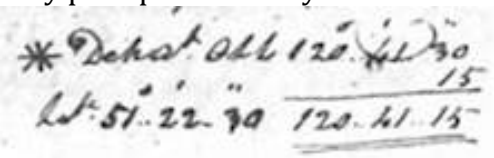
Dle atte Qi Ll

2. 15. 40	100. 22. 30
16. 30	10. 0
17. 13	99. 58. 45
2. 16. 28	100. 10. 25
	15
	100. 10. 10

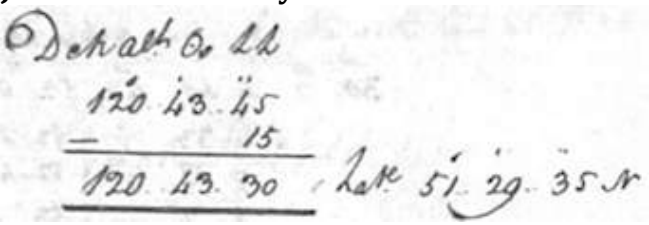
30th Monday – Strong Wind at NW till 3 PM when it calmed & we got under way & went along Lake Winnipeg the following Courses – NbW ¾. NbE ¼ - N ½ E 4 across a Bay 5 miles deep with a pretty stout river flowing into it – NbE 5 to the N End of a Big Island – NbE ¾ thro a narrow between the Large & a Smaller Is^d & put up at 7 ½ PM – Called Buffalo head at the End of the NbE 5 mile Course Saw 20 Bungees who wishes us very much to make a Settlement near here – as they say the Canadians use them very ill in every respect.

1808

May 31st Tuesday – at 4#.20' AM got underway – went among Isd NNE 1 ½. NWbN 1 ½ to the Northwestern extremity of the Big Isd – NNW 1 along the East side, NW 3. & the Broken River falls in here, where the Canadians had a House – found here Mr Campbell with 1 Canoe & 6 men who has been trading this Winter with those Bungees we saw Yesterday. WbN 4 – NW 2 * these last three Courses a great number of Small rocky Islands close along the Shore – NW ½ N 9 & obliged to put up for wind at 2 ¾ PM. Met 4 Canoes of Freemen in 4 Large Canoes 22 men, they are going to Hunt in the Athapescow Country. they put up 2 miles beyond us.



June 1st Wednesday –



Strong Gales of Wind could not Embark.

2nd Thursday – at 3 AM got underway & went NW ¼ N 1 ¼. NNE ¾ between two Islands called Straights La Duc a Canadian who was drownded of that name in 1773 – obliged to put up here the Wind blowing very fresh. The Freemen in Company with us. They very much wish that our Company would give them Money or Bills to be drawn in Montreal for all the Furs they kill over and above what they will require for Trading their necessaries with in this Country

3rd Friday – At 6 ¾ AM got underway & went N 2 from the Isd to the East Shore then along it NWbW 3 – Do 1 ½ - Do ½ - Do 2 - Do 2 – WNW ½ N 2 – Do 2 ½ - NNW 2 – WNW 3 Do ¾ Dogs head on opposite side bears SWbW 2 ½ - N ¼ - NNE ¼ Blood river on the right fall in – NNE 1 these three Courses among rocky Isd: NE 3 ½ - NNW 1 ½ - NWbW 2 - WbS 5 these 4 courses along a deep Bay WbN ¾ - NW ¼ - N ¼ & put up at 7#.30' PM – Observed the Sun to set N 62° ½ W P[er] Compass

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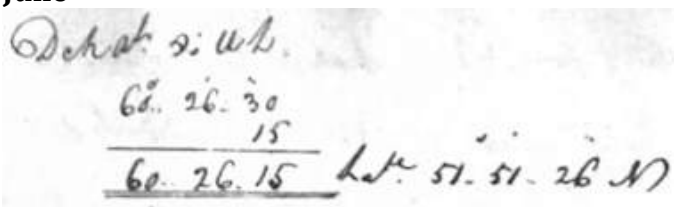
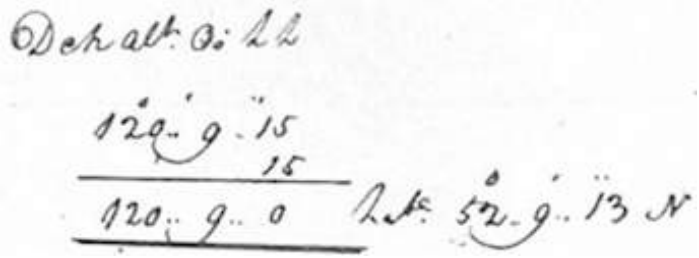
June

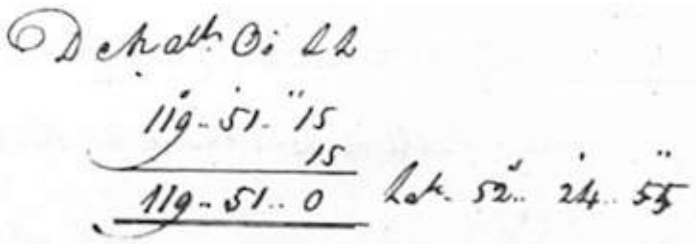


4th Saturday – at 3#.25' AM got underway & went along the right hand or East side of Lake Winnipeg as usual. NbW 2 – NbE 4 Beaver river (small) on the right & many small rocky Isd – NW 4 – WNW 2 & passed the Swampy river (small) WNW 4 – NNW ½ W 5 & passed Catfish river (small) – NNW ½ W ½ - NWbN 1.



NNW ½ N 2 ½ - NW 3 & 1 – N ½ W 5 ½ across a Bay 7 miles deep at the bottom of which is Pigeon river, & a Canadian House. NWbN 3 & put up on a small rocky Isd at 7 ½ PM – a pretty Large river falls in on the Right, the Canadians go up in Large Canoes to their Settlements towards Severn Factory. –

5th Sunday – Got underway at 4 ½ AM & went NWbN 1 ½ to a Long Sandy narrow point & obliged to remain here for Wind.



6th Monday – At 5 ½ PM we got underway & went NNW 7 & put up. all the way from river Winnipeg to this Sandy Point the shores are rocky in general & low – here & to the North of the Sandy point the shores are generally low paved with some few rocks in Places, small scrub wood.

1808

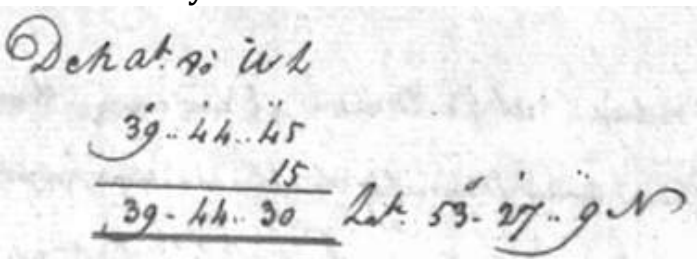
June 7th Tuesday – A Strong Gale at ENE & Snow, Embarked at 5 ½ AM & went along the Lake the following courses – NW ½ N 6 & passed Leaf river – NW 8 – NW ½ N 6 & obliged to put up at 4 ½ PM for wind & rain – very cold weather

8th Wednesday – Strong Wind till 9 AM when we embarked & went NWbN 5 – NNW 1 ½ - NbE ¾ - NEbN 3 – EbN 6 & entered the Poplar river went up it EbN ½ - SE ¼ - EbN ¼ - ESE ¼ - EbN ½ a small Is^d & 2 Houses – found one Tent of Inds here – expected to have found Mr Thomas Swain here, who is going this way to Survey the Track Down to Severn, for their Batteaux to pass thro, he was not yet arrived. all these Courses this Day very rocky Shores, but low & a vast number of small rocky Is^d near the Shore. Poplar river from 20 to 50 Yds wide very easy Current with Rocky & grassy low Banks. Returned back to the Entrance of the River & went along the right hand side of the Bay – WbS 2 – WbN 2 & put up at 6 ½ PM. very cold weather.

9th Thursday – Embarked at 6 ½ AM, & went WNW 3 – NNW ½ W 8 & 1 & passed the Black river in a small Bay – went across the Bay NWbN 3 – NW ½ N 6 Low rocky shores & small wood – put up at 6 PM for heavy rain & wind.

10th Friday – Lay by all Day for Snow & rain – at the White Fall the Snow fell there 13 Inches deep & it required 4 Days fine weather to intirely melt it off the Ground – a remarkable circumstance at this Season of the Year.

11th Saturday –



At 2#.45' PM got underway went NWbN 4 – NWbN 8 – NW ½ N 6 – NW ½ N 7 – NWbN 3 – NNW ½ N 5 entrance of Big Lake & Junction of the Saskatchewan Track to Cumberland House by the Great Rapid & put up at 7 ½ PM –

1808

June We met Mr Thomas Swain 10 miles from the Entrance of the Lake he got my Canoe & the two men who accompanied me down the Red River – he is to proceed direct for Severn Factory by the way of Poplar river. Remained together 4 hours. He expects to find a Pilot at the Black river that Mr Kennedy had orders to procure for that purpose last fall. –

P. Fidler.